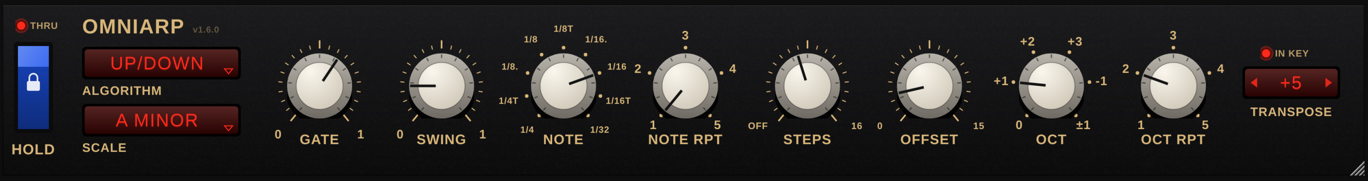
OMNIARP

ADVANCED MIDI ARPEGGIATOR

USER MANUAL - VERSION 1.6.0


THRU
OMNIARP
v1.6.0
UP/DOWN
ALGORITHM
A MINOR
SCALE
HOLD
0
GATE
1
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SWING
1
1/8T
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1/8.
1/16
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NOTE
3
2
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5
NOTE RPT
OFF
STEPS
16
0
OFFSET
15
+2
+3
+1
-1
0
±1
OCT
3
2
4
1
5
OCT RPT
IN KEY
+5
TRANSPOSE

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Welcome

Omniarp is a MIDI arpeggiator that goes further than a classic arp. Hold a chord and it is turned into a pattern locked to your host's tempo, shaped by eleven algorithms, octave modes, note and octave repeats, gate and swing.

Formats: VST3 and AU on macOS (Apple Silicon and Intel), VST3 on Windows, VST3 and LV2 on Linux.

Installation

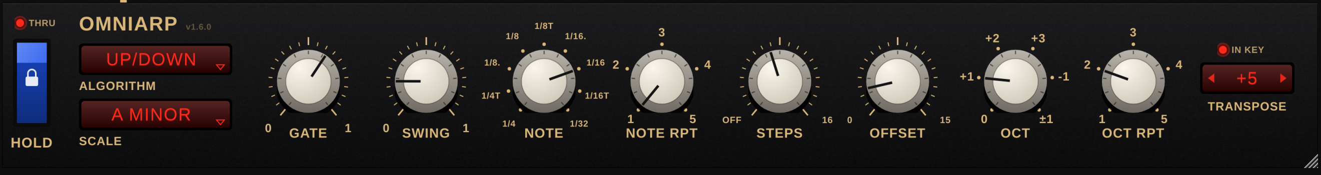
macOS	Run **Omniarp-Mac.pkg**. It installs the AU to /Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/Components and the VST3 to /Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/VST3.
Windows	Unzip **Omniarp-Windows-VST3.zip** and copy **Omniarp.vst3** to C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3.
Linux	Extract **Omniarp-Linux.tar.gz** and copy Omniarp.vst3 to ~/.vst3 and Omniarp.lv2 to ~/.lv2.

Setting up in your DAW

Omniarp produces notes, not sound. It loads as an instrument that sends MIDI out, so you route its notes to the synth you want to play.

Ableton Live	Put Omniarp on MIDI track 1 (it appears under Plug-Ins as an instrument; use the VST3). Create MIDI track 2 with your synth, set its MIDI From to track 1 and choose Omniarp, and set Monitor to In. Play or record on track 1.
Logic Pro	Load Omniarp as an instrument and route its MIDI output to another instrument track via the track's MIDI input.
Other hosts	Insert it on an instrument track before the synth, or route its MIDI output to another track.

The panel



HOLD	The blue switch latches the chord. With HOLD on, the arp keeps playing after you release the keys. Play a new chord (after letting go of all keys) to replace it; keys added while others are still down join the chord. Turning HOLD off releases any latched notes you are no longer holding.
THRU	The small light above HOLD. When it is on, the keys you play go straight to your synth as normal notes and the arp keeps playing the chord it already has. Typical use: latch a chord with HOLD, switch THRU on and play a bass line over the arp. To change the arp chord, switch THRU off, play the new chord, then switch THRU on again. Notes started with THRU on always get their note-off, even if you switch THRU off while holding them.
ALGORITHM	The red display shows the current pattern. Click it to choose from the list.
SCALE	The second red display sets a key and scale (Major, Minor, Dorian, Phrygian, Lydian, Mixolydian, Harmonic Minor, Pentatonic Major/Minor, Blues). When a scale is on, Omniarp plays every note of that scale from your lowest held note up to your highest (at least one octave), so even a single key becomes a melodic run. Click it to choose the key (KEY submenu) and scale. OFF plays just the notes you hold.
GATE	Length of each note as a fraction of a step. Low values are short and staccato; 1 is fully legato.
SWING	Delays every second step. At 0 the timing is straight; at 1 the off-beat is pushed half a step late.
NOTE	Step rate, locked to the host tempo: 1/4, 1/4T, 1/8., 1/8, 1/8T, 1/16., 1/16, 1/16T, 1/32 (T = triplet, dot = dotted).
NOTE RPT	Plays each note 1 to 5 times before moving to the next one.
STEPS	Pattern length. OFF plays the whole pattern; 1 to 16 loops only the first N steps. Odd lengths such as 3, 5 or 7 against a 4/4 beat create shifting polyrhythms.
OFFSET	Starts the pattern N steps later (0 to 15) without changing its notes, so a different note lands on the beat. With C E G B on UP: 0 plays C E G B, 1 plays E G B C, 2 plays G B C E. With STEPS on, the offset works inside the loop (STEPS 3, OFFSET 1 plays steps 2 3 1). Offsets larger than the pattern wrap around.
OCT	Octave range: 0 (played octave only), +1, +2, +3 (upwards), -1 (one octave down), ±1 (one octave below, the played octave, then one above).
OCT RPT	How many times the whole pattern cycles in an octave before moving to the next octave (1 to 5).
TRANSPOSE	Shifts the arp from -12 to +12 semitones. Click the arrows on the red screen to go down or up one semitone, click the number for a grid of every value (jump straight to +7 without passing +1 to +6, or pick 0 to reset), or Alt/Option-click the number to reset to 0. Changes always land on the next arp step, never mid-note.
IN KEY	The small light above TRANSPOSE. When it is on and a SCALE is selected, transposed notes snap to the nearest note of that scale, so transposing never plays notes outside the key.

Click the OMNIARP title to open the About panel; click anywhere on it to close it. Drag the bottom-right corner to resize the window (60% to 200%); the size is saved with your project.

Algorithms

Examples use a held chord of C, E, G, B (lowest to highest). Held notes are always sorted by pitch.

1. UP	Lowest to highest. C E G B
2. DOWN	Highest to lowest. B G E C
3. UP/DOWN	Up then down, without repeating the top and bottom notes. C E G B G E
4. FOLDBACK	Up then down, repeating the top and bottom notes. C E G B B G E C
5. UP SKIP	Climbs while jumping ahead two notes. C G E B G B
6. DOWN SKIP	The mirror of Up Skip, descending. B E G C E C
7. PEDAL UP	The lowest note alternates with each note above it, going up. C E C G C B
8. PEDAL DOWN	The highest note alternates with each note below it, going down. B G B E B C
9. PEDAL RAND	The lowest note alternates with a random note from the rest of the chord. C ? C ? C ?
10. RAND	Every step is a random note from the chord.
11. CHORD	The whole chord plays on every step, which is great for rhythmic stabs with GATE and SWING.

How the controls combine

The final sequence is built in layers: the algorithm makes the basic pattern, NOTE RPT repeats each note in it, OCT RPT repeats the whole pattern, and OCT moves that through the octave range. For example, UP with NOTE RPT 2, OCT +1 and OCT RPT 1 on C E G plays: C C E E G G, then C' C' E' E' G' G' an octave higher.

Timing

While the host is playing, Omniarp locks to its timeline, so patterns land on the grid and follow loops and jumps. When the transport is stopped, it keeps running on its own clock at the host tempo, so you can play along without pressing play.

Support

Questions, bug reports or ideas: ticcoross@gmail.com